

Travelers Home Claims — Data Definitions and Key Metrics

Audience: Data analysts in Personal Lines

Last reviewed: Q1 2026 | Owner: Claims Analytics Team

Overview

This document defines the fields, statuses, and metrics used in Travelers home insurance claims reporting. It is the authoritative reference for claim data questions. Questions about coverage eligibility, underwriting decisions, or policy terms are out of scope — see the Coverage Types Reference.

Claim Lifecycle and Status Codes

A home insurance claim moves through a defined set of statuses from the time it is reported to the time it is closed:

Status Code	Label	Meaning
OPEN	Open	Claim has been reported and is being actively worked
PEND	Pending	Claim is waiting on information from the customer, a vendor, or an inspector
RSRV	Reserved	An initial reserve has been set; payment has not yet been made
PAID	Paid	At least one payment has been made; claim may still be open
CLSD	Closed	All payments made, claim is complete; no further activity expected
VOID	Void	Claim was entered in error or is a duplicate
DENY	Denied	Claim was reviewed and determined to be not covered

A claim can move between OPEN, PEND, and RSRV multiple times before reaching PAID or CLSD. A CLSD claim can be reopened if new information is submitted.

Core Claim Data Fields

Claim Identification

claim_id — Unique identifier for the claim. Format: TRV-YYYY-XXXXXXXX. Never reused.

policy_id — The policy record the claim is filed against. A single policy can have multiple claims.

reported_date — The date the claim was first reported to Travelers, regardless of when the loss occurred.

loss_date — The date the covered event occurred. For storms, this is the storm date. For theft, it is the date the theft was discovered.

Loss Categorization

peril_code — the primary cause of loss. Common codes in the home book:

WIND — Wind and hail

FIRE — Fire and smoke

WATER_INT — Internal water (burst pipes, appliance leaks, water backup)

WATER_EXT — External water (surface flooding — note: typically DENIED under standard HO-3)

THEFT — Theft or burglary

LIAB — Liability claim

OTHER — Does not fit a primary category; requires manual review

coverage_triggered — which coverage letter was activated (A, B, C, D, E, or F). A single claim can trigger multiple coverages.

Financial Fields

initial_reserve — The first dollar estimate of how much the claim will cost. Set by the adjuster within 24–48 hours. Not a payment — it is a liability estimate for financial reporting.

total_incurred — Current total cost of the claim: all payments made plus the remaining open reserve.

total_paid — Total dollars actually paid out on the claim as of the reporting date.

recovery_amount — Money recovered through subrogation or salvage. Reduces net loss.

deductible_applied — The deductible amount collected from the customer, which reduces the payment Travelers makes.

Timing Fields

days_to_first_contact — Days from reported_date to first adjuster contact with the customer. Target is 1 business day.

days_to_close — Days from reported_date to CLSD status. A key cycle-time metric.

reopen_count — Number of times the claim was reopened after reaching CLSD status.

Key Performance Metrics

Loss Ratio

The core profitability metric for the home line.

Formula: Loss Ratio = (Total Incurred Losses + Loss Adjustment Expenses) / Earned Premium

A loss ratio below 60% is generally healthy for home. During catastrophe years, it can spike above 100%. Calculated at the region, state, and book level — not stored at the claim level.

Severity

Average dollar amount paid per closed claim.

Formula: Severity = Total Paid / Number of Closed Claims

Severity varies significantly by peril. Fire claims are typically the highest severity. Liability claims have high variance.

Frequency

Number of claims per 100 (or 1,000) insured homes over a period.

Formula: Frequency = (Claim Count / Earned House Years) x 100

Earned house years = total number of home-years of coverage in force. A policy in force for a full year = 1.0 house year.

Cycle Time

Average days_to_close across a set of claims.

Tracked by region, adjuster team, and peril type. Long cycle times correlate with lower customer satisfaction scores and higher supplemental claim rates.

Catastrophe (CAT) Claims

Claims tied to a declared catastrophe event are flagged with a **cat_code** in the data. CAT claims are handled differently:

Assigned to dedicated CAT teams, not standard adjusters.

Cycle time targets are extended.

CAT claims are excluded from many standard performance reports to avoid distorting non-CAT metrics.

CAT codes are assigned using industry-standard definitions (ISO/PCS catastrophe declarations).

If a claim has a **cat_code** value, exclude it from frequency, severity, and cycle time comparisons against non-CAT baselines unless the analysis is specifically about catastrophe performance.

Common Data Quality Issues

1. **loss_date after reported_date** — Data entry error; should be flagged and reviewed.
2. **Zero initial_reserve on non-voided claims** — Occurs when the claim was recorded before the adjuster completed the initial review. Not reliable for reserve analysis.
3. **peril_code = OTHER at high rates** — If more than 10–15% of claims show OTHER, it usually indicates a classification issue, not an unusual loss pattern.
4. **Duplicate claim_id entries** — Rare but occurs after system migrations. One record will have VOID status.